

Conversation

#04

CONVERSATION

CONDOMINIUM MEETING

Teacher's note: get 6 pieces of papers, number them 1 to 6 and have each student draw one, to see which character they will be.

Tonight is the monthly meeting at your condominium meeting. All residents are there to give their suggestions and, mostly, to put their complaints into discussion.

1 Apartment 302: you are 26, a housewife. You have 2 young kids, 6 and 8 years old who all other residents regard as the brats, but you, obviously, don't share their opinion. You also have a dog, a Yorkshire. Your complaint is about the barbecue area: it is not properly cleaned after parties; there are beer cans and other dangers to your kids and dog. There should also be more room in the playground area for them.

2 Apartment 202: you are 82, retired business man, very tired at this age and discipline is a must for you. You want some peace and quiet, even during the day, so that you can lie down and rest. The kids and Yorkshire in **apartment 302**, just above you, won't let you. They wear inline skates at house and the Yorkshire barks for any and no specific reason. Whenever they do that you bang the broomstick against the ceiling, which is their floor, and cry out loud: "That's outrageous."

3 Apartment 303: you are 18, living with your aunt, who is 80. She's got Alzheimer's and is in bed all the time. You study at least 12h a day because you are trying one the most difficult public universities in the country. The kids and Yorkshire next door won't let you study. You don't mind the noise and scattered beer cans in the barbecue area. After all, every once and a while you are invited to join the **Apartment 404** gang, which you do, whenever possible. And talking about scattered beer cans, you think that clearing any mess in the building is the janitor's job.

4 Apartment 404: 24, single free as a bird in the wild. Your father is a banker and you have all the modern high tech gadgets that dad's money can buy you. Your stereo is far more powerful than any nightclub in town. For some reason, someone whose voice seems an elderly person's, keeps shouting: "It's outrageous!" when you are playing it at high volume. You like to entertain and be entertained, of course. So, every Saturday night you invite friends over and you throw what they call 'far out' parties in the barbecue area until 1:00 a.m. Obviously, no one could possibly be collecting beer cans at that time, when poor friends must leave because of some stupid condominium regulation. Nobody works on Sundays (well, you don't work at all), so why not party till sunrise? During the next meeting you are going to ask why some people like to pick on you.

5 Apartment 606: you are 39, you run a home delivery pizza service from your flat. You need your motorbike at the most unthinkable times. According to building regulations your bike must be parked in a tiny corner, between two pillars but someone keeps parking behind it and you cannot leave because of the pillars. You cannot remember how many pizzas you couldn't deliver on time because of that. You not only do not sell those pizzas, but they are also lost if not delivered.

6 Janitor: you are 49, a retired accountant and, obviously, everything has its time and place. You obviously can be neither for or against any resident, unless they are complaining about someone who is breaking a condominium rule and rules are like an Excel table, everything in its right place. You must listen to all and try to make them compromise. You also have your complaints.

COMPOSITION

Write about a problem you or your family has had with a neighbor. Who was wrong and who was right? How was the situation resolved?

Full name: _____

Theme: _____

Title: _____

This image shows a single sheet of white paper with horizontal ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.